

“By taking these seven steps, you have become mine forever and I have become yours. I am the sky and you are the earth. I am the mind and you are the word. I am (Saama) music and you are the song (Rig).”

~ Yajur Veda

“As the heavens are stable, as the earth is stable, as the mountains are stable, as the whole universe is stable, so may our union be permanent and full of love.”

~ Rig Veda

Breakfast (until 9am)

8:00 Bride entrance
8:30 Groom entrance

*Prayer to Vishwakshena
Tying of sacred wrist band*

9:00 Kasi Yatra / Garland exchange
Elders' blessings

9:45 Bride and Groom enter
mandapam

10:00 Groom is welcomed
Groom gives 9yd saree to Bride

10:30 Bride changes into 9yd saree
Prayers to Agni

10:45 Bride's parents agree to give the
Bride away
Prayer for a perfect marriage

11:00 Groom ties Thirumangalyam
around the Bride's neck

11:15 Couple go around the fire 7 times,
taking 7 sacred vows

11:30 Offering of puffed rice to the fire
Stepping on stone
Wearing toering

11:45 Blessings for the new couple
Final rituals

noon Lunch (until 1pm)

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Sri Ramajayam



Synopsis of Vedic Wedding Proceeding



NINA & ANDREW

Marriage

Friday August 23, 2024

Preparatory

Vrutham - The bride's and groom's families pledge to go through with the ceremony, and honor the vows made during it.

Vishvaksena Puja - Vishvasena is Lord Vishnu's commander-in-chief. Like all Vaishnavite rituals start by praying to Vishvaksena to remove hurdles.

Kanganam: Bracelet - Holy threads are tied around the wrists of the couple to ward off evil.

Kasi Yatra: Holy Pilgrimage - The groom starts on a holy pilgrimage to pursue religious studies. The bride's father intercepts him, and convinces him to return, marry his daughter, and live well before retiring.

Malai Matral: Garlanding - The bride and the groom exchange garlands conveying mutual desire for marriage and companionship.

Unjal: Swing - The couple sits on a swing and gently sway, signifying that "As the swing goes forwards and backwards, so does life." Women sing songs to celebrate, and the elders bless the couple.

Ankurarpanam: Palligai - Germinated grains are placed in earthen cups symbolizing the creation of new life.

Vara Puja / Vara Prekshanam - Bride's family honorably welcomes the groom.

Koorai / 9 yards Saree - Groom gives the Koorai as a sign of acceptance and to welcome her into the family.

Ceremony



The ceremony is conducted in front of the sacred Agni (fire) as a witness to the marriage.

Kanyadaanam: Giving the Bride Away - Bride's parents consent to the alliance.

Nugathadi: The Yoke - On the grass ring, a yoke with "Thirumangalyam" (marriage chain) is placed. It teaches the couple to walk in step through life, with balanced speed as do animals in a yoke, pulling the burden of life together.

The bride goes inside to change and returns wearing the traditional koorai (9 yards saree).

Mangalyadhaaranam: Tying the Knot - Bride is seated on her father's lap facing East. Groom stands facing West. With a little water poured into his hand by the bride's father, solemnizing the betrothal, the groom says to the bride, "With this blessed ornament I place around your neck, may we gain everlasting companionship. May I be blessed with longevity to take care of you." The groom then ties a special straw belt around the bride's waist and prays to Agni.

Panigrahanam: Taking Her Hand - The groom takes the bride's right hand, thumb and all fingers together in his right hand. The closed fingers of the right hand of the bride represent her heart, and she is surrendering it.

Sapthapathi: Seven Steps - The groom helps the bride take seven steps proclaiming the following:

1. Having taken these 7 steps - You have become my best friend.
2. May we never part company.
3. May we grow close in love.
4. May we complement each other in life.
5. May we become of the same mind.
6. May we live as though you were "RIG" and I "SAMA" of the Vedas.
7. May we beget good children and gain worldly as well as spiritual wealth.

Ammi Midithal: Stepping Stone, and Metti: Toe ring - Groom to bride, "Please ascend this stone. Be solid and steadfast through life's ups and downs, and be the source of my strength."

Poriyidal Lajahomam: Puffed Rice Offering - Bride's brother helps the couple make an offering of puffed rice to Agni, and she then prays for a long & healthy life for her husband.

Asheervaadam - The newlyweds seek blessings from their parents & elders - they are showered with turmeric coated rice and flowers.

Mangala Aarathi - To protect the bride and groom from evil eyes, a special solution of turmeric powder and lime is circled around the couple. The grass belt is removed and Varuna, the water god is invoked to bless her with a life free of ailments, and to give the couple good children.

*In the evening two stars in the heavens are pointed out to the newly married couple. **DHRUVA** (Pole star) for its unchanging position, and **ARUNDHATI** - a star representing a loyal wife.*

Grihapravesham: Entering the New Household - All the divine spirits are invoked to bless the couple in their new household.

The groom welcomes the new bride into his house thus, "Welcome to OUR house, which you shall rule over. Bring happiness and love into it."

